mobile, compact, commandable robots that can diagnose and repair their own malfunctions. There are likely to be many more of this tribe in the near future.

It is conventional wisdom now that anything built by the government will be a disaster. But the two *Voyager* spacecraft were built by the government (in partnership with that other bugaboo, academia). They came in at cost, on time, and vastly exceeded their design specifications—as well as the fondest dreams of their makers. Seeking not to control, threaten, wound, or destroy, these elegant machines represent the exploratory part of our nature set free to roam the Solar System and beyond. This kind of technology, the treasures it uncovers freely available to all humans everywhere, has been, over the last few decades, one of the few activities of the United States admired as much by those who abhor many of its policies as by those who agree with it on every issue. *Voyager* cost each American less than a penny a year from launch to Neptune encounter. Missions to the planets are one of those things—and I mean this not just for the United States, but for the human species—that we do best.

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*Since women astronauts and cosmonauts of several nations have flown in space, "manned" is just flat-out incorrect. I've attempted to find an alternative to this widely used term, coined in a more unself-consciously sexist age. I tried "crewed" for a while, but in spoken language it lends itself to misunderstanding. "Piloted" doesn't work, because even commercial airplanes have robot pilots. "Manned and womanned" is just, but unwieldy. Perhaps the best compromise is "human," which permits us to distinguish crisply between human and robotic missions. But every now and then, I find "human" not quite working, and to my dismay "manned" slips back in.